WEEK 10 · LECTURE L1 · UNIT IV

Mentoring, Coaching and Sponsorship Programs

Formal and informal mentoring, matching, reverse mentoring, and how to evaluate a development program.

R K Singh · Senior Professor, Department of Commerce · Delhi School of Economics, University of Delhi

DSEH004 · Performance Management and Employee Engagement · M.Com. PGCF 2025 · Exam preparation edition

AFTER THIS LECTURE YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO

What this lecture prepares you for

- Compare formal and informal mentoring and what makes either work.
- Design a matching process that balances similarity and equity.
- Explain reverse mentoring and what it builds.
- Evaluate a program with Kirkpatrick's four levels.

COURSE OUTCOMES

CLO 5 (create talent development programs) and CLO 1 (design integrated systems).

COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

A formal mentoring program can reproduce what good informal mentoring does.

Agree or disagree. What is hard to assign?

Formal and informal mentoring

THE CORE IDEA

Proteges of informal mentors received more career and psychosocial support, and higher pay, than proteges of formal mentors.

HOW IT WORKS

Yet satisfaction with the relationship mattered more than whether it was formal or informal.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Self reported support; informal pairs may form between people already likely to succeed.

IN PRACTICE

A bank stops counting pairs created and starts measuring the quality of each relationship.

EXAM LENS

Design formal programs for relationship quality, not for the number of pairs.

MATCHING

Who should be paired with whom?

ENSHER AND MURPHY (1997)

Proteges who saw their mentors as similar reported more liking, satisfaction and support.

THE EQUITY RISK

Matching on similarity alone reproduces existing networks and excludes those unlike current leaders.

VOICE IN MATCHING

Giving participants a say in the match can build commitment to it.

THEORY IN DEPTH · MURPHY (2012)

Reverse mentoring

THE CORE IDEA

Junior employees mentor senior ones, often on technology or new markets.

HOW IT WORKS

It builds learning across generations and develops leadership skill in the junior mentor.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Status gaps can make juniors hold back; it needs psychological safety to work.

IN PRACTICE

A young data analyst mentors a senior plant head on digital quality tools and learns the business in return.

EXAM LENS

Use it as a design that serves both parties. Link it to the lifespan view of age from Week 8.

Four levels of evaluation

Level	Question	Caution
Reaction	Did participants like it?	Only weakly related to learning or transfer
Learning	Did they learn?	Tests in class differ from work
Behavior	Do they act differently at work?	Needs observation over time
Results	Did outcomes change?	Many other causes are possible

EXAM LENS

Alliger et al. (1997): reactions about usefulness related to transfer better than enjoyment did.

COMPARE AND EVALUATE

Three development relationships

	Mentoring	Coaching	Sponsorship
Focus	Whole career and person	A specific skill or goal	Advancement
Duration	Long	Short to medium	At key decisions
Evidence	Small average effects (Eby et al.)	Positive meta analytic effects	Mainly correlational
Main risk	Low quality pairs	Skill without context	Unequal access

PRACTICE FOR THE END TERM EXAMINATION

Questions to rehearse

Design a formal mentoring program for an Indian company and explain how you would evaluate it. **20 marks**

A strong answer: uses Ragins et al. on quality; Ensher and Murphy on matching with equity safeguards; Kirkpatrick and Alliger et al. for evaluation.

"Mentoring helps, but less than organizations believe." Discuss with evidence. **20 marks**

A strong answer: reports Eby et al.; contrasts formal and informal; explains why effects vary; recommends design features.

Explain Kirkpatrick's four levels. **10 marks**

A strong answer: names and explains each; one caution for each level.

CARRY THESE INTO THE EXAMINATION

Three things to remember

1. Relationship quality matters more than formal or informal status
2. Matching on similarity alone reproduces existing networks
3. Enjoyment is a poor measure of a program; usefulness is better

SET READINGS · FROM THE LESSON PLAN

Read for this lecture

Eby, L. T., Allen, T. D., Evans, S. C., Ng, T., & DuBois, D. L. (2008). Does mentoring matter? A multidisciplinary meta analysis comparing mentored and non mentored individuals. *Journal of Vocational Behavior, 72*(2), 254–267.

Jennings, C. (2013). *70:20:10 framework explained* [Practitioner monograph]. (Listed in the Lesson Plan; year not independently confirmed.)

Pfeffer, J. (1998). *The human equation: Building profits by putting people first*. Harvard Business School Press. Chapter 2.

HOW TO USE THESE

These are the Week 10 set readings. Eby et al. (2008) is the core reading for this lecture. Jennings (2013) is a practitioner piece; its year could not be independently confirmed.

Sources for this lecture (1 of 3)

Works named on the slides of this lecture. They are background sources, not set readings.

Alliger, G. M., Tannenbaum, S. I., Bennett, W., Traver, H., & Shotland, A. (1997). A meta analysis of the relations among training criteria. *Personnel Psychology, 50*(2), 341–358. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1744-6570.1997.tb00911.x

Eby, L. T., Allen, T. D., Evans, S. C., Ng, T., & DuBois, D. L. (2008). Does mentoring matter? A multidisciplinary meta analysis comparing mentored and non mentored individuals. *Journal of Vocational Behavior, 72*(2), 254–267. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jvb.2007.04.005

Ensher, E. A., & Murphy, S. E. (1997). Effects of race, gender, perceived similarity, and contact on mentor relationships. *Journal of Vocational Behavior, 50*(3), 460–481. https://doi.org/10.1006/jvbe.1996.1547

Sources for this lecture (2 of 3)

Kirkpatrick, D. L. (1994). *Evaluating training programs: The four levels*. Berrett Koehler.

Murphy, W. M. (2012). Reverse mentoring at work: Fostering cross generational learning and developing millennial leaders. *Human Resource Management, 51*(4), 549–573. https://doi.org/10.1002/hrm.21489

Ragins, B. R., & Cotton, J. L. (1999). Mentor functions and outcomes: A comparison of men and women in formal and informal mentoring relationships. *Journal of Applied Psychology, 84*(4), 529–550. https://doi.org/10.1037/0021-9010.84.4.529

Sources for this lecture (3 of 3)

Ragins, B. R., Cotton, J. L., & Miller, J. S. (2000). Marginal mentoring: The effects of type of mentor, quality of relationship, and program design on work and career attitudes. *Academy of Management Journal, 43*(6), 1177–1194. https://doi.org/10.2307/1556344